Target User Definition

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Purpose of this document
This document defines the target users of the UniApp project, outlines their roles and characteristics, and clarifies how they are considered throughout the different phases of the project. The definition is preliminary and will be refined during the user research phase.

Primary Users
University students involved in research-oriented or project-based courses

Description
The primary users of UniApp are university students who are required to manage multiple academic activities simultaneously, such as coursework, research tasks, deadlines, documentation, and communication with supervisors.
These students often rely on a combination of institutional platforms (e.g. learning management systems, student portals), email, and personal tools to organize their academic responsibilities. Their academic workload is characterized by parallel tasks, changing deadlines, and varying levels of autonomy.

Key characteristics
- Enrolled in undergraduate or graduate programs
- Participating in research-based, project-based, or thesis-related courses
- Regularly interacting with multiple digital academic tools
- Often accessing academic information on mobile devices

Needs (assumed)
- Clear overview of academic tasks and deadlines
- Easy access to relevant project and course information
- Reduced fragmentation across platforms
- Support for organizing research or project-related work

Secondary Users
Academic supervisors

Description
Academic supervisors are considered secondary users. While they are not the primary users of the application, their role influences how students structure their work, document progress, and communicate outcomes.

Supervisors may indirectly interact with outputs generated through the app, such as documentation, summaries, or project artifacts.

Role in the project
- Provide guidance, feedback, and evaluation
- Define academic expectations and constraints
- Influence project timelines and deliverables

Assumptions (to be validated)
At this stage of the project, the following assumptions guide the definition of the target users:
- Students experience fragmentation across academic tools and platforms
- Students rely heavily on mobile devices for quick access to academic information
- Students struggle to maintain a clear overview of research or project-related tasks

These assumptions will be explored and validated during the user research phase.

Open Questions
The following questions remain open and will be addressed through exploratory user research:
- How do students currently organize their academic work across tools?
- Which academic activities cause the most confusion or friction?
- What information do students need quick access to on a daily basis?
- How do students perceive existing university systems?

Comments

The target user definition is clear and appropriately scoped. It correctly identifies students as the primary user group and considers their academic context and constraints.

For the next iteration, I recommend specifying whether the focus is on undergraduate, postgraduate, or international students, as their needs and institutional interactions may differ significantly. This clarification will help guide the research approach and later design decisions.

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